



Plan, prepare and display a buffet service

D1.HCC.CL2.07

Trainee Manual



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Specialist centre
for foods, tourism
& hospitality

Project Base

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The Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) was established on 8 August 1967. The Member States of the Association are Brunei Darussalam, Cambodia, Indonesia, Lao PDR, Malaysia, Myanmar, Philippines, Singapore, Thailand and Viet Nam.

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Introduction to trainee manual

To the Trainee

Congratulations on joining this course. This Trainee Manual is one part of a 'toolbox' which is a resource provided to trainees, trainers and assessors to help you become competent in various areas of your work.

The 'toolbox' consists of three elements:

- A Trainee Manual for you to read and study at home or in class
- A Trainer Guide with Power Point slides to help your Trainer explain the content of the training material and provide class activities to help with practice
- An Assessment Manual which provides your Assessor with oral and written questions and other assessment tasks to establish whether or not you have achieved competency.

The first thing you may notice is that this training program and the information you find in the Trainee Manual seems different to the textbooks you have used previously. This is because the method of instruction and examination is different. The method used is called Competency based training (CBT) and Competency based assessment (CBA). CBT and CBA is the training and assessment system chosen by ASEAN (Association of South-East Asian Nations) to train people to work in the tourism and hospitality industry throughout all the ASEAN member states.

What is the CBT and CBA system and why has it been adopted by ASEAN?

CBT is a way of training that concentrates on what a worker can do or is required to do at work. The aim of the training is to enable trainees to perform tasks and duties at a standard expected by employers. CBT seeks to develop the skills, knowledge and attitudes (or recognise the ones the trainee already possesses) to achieve the required competency standard. ASEAN has adopted the CBT/CBA training system as it is able to produce the type of worker that industry is looking for and this therefore increases trainees chances of obtaining employment.

CBA involves collecting evidence and making a judgement of the extent to which a worker can perform his/her duties at the required competency standard. Where a trainee can already demonstrate a degree of competency, either due to prior training or work experience, a process of 'Recognition of Prior Learning' (RPL) is available to trainees to recognise this. Please speak to your trainer about RPL if you think this applies to you.

What is a competency standard?

Competency standards are descriptions of the skills and knowledge required to perform a task or activity at the level of a required standard.

242 competency standards for the tourism and hospitality industries throughout the ASEAN region have been developed to cover all the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to work in the following occupational areas:

- Housekeeping
- Food Production
- Food and Beverage Service

- Front Office
- Travel Agencies
- Tour Operations.

All of these competency standards are available for you to look at. In fact you will find a summary of each one at the beginning of each Trainee Manual under the heading 'Unit Descriptor'. The unit descriptor describes the content of the unit you will be studying in the Trainee Manual and provides a table of contents which are divided up into 'Elements' and 'Performance Criteria'. An element is a description of one aspect of what has to be achieved in the workplace. The 'Performance Criteria' below each element details the level of performance that needs to be demonstrated to be declared competent.

There are other components of the competency standard:

- *Unit Title*: statement about what is to be done in the workplace
- *Unit Number*: unique number identifying the particular competency
- *Nominal hours*: number of classroom or practical hours usually needed to complete the competency. We call them 'nominal' hours because they can vary e.g. sometimes it will take an individual less time to complete a unit of competency because he/she has prior knowledge or work experience in that area.

The final heading you will see before you start reading the Trainee Manual is the 'Assessment Matrix'. Competency based assessment requires trainees to be assessed in at least 2 – 3 different ways, one of which must be practical. This section outlines three ways assessment can be carried out and includes work projects, written questions and oral questions. The matrix is designed to show you which performance criteria will be assessed and how they will be assessed. Your trainer and/or assessor may also use other assessment methods including 'Observation Checklist' and 'Third Party Statement'. An observation checklist is a way of recording how you perform at work and a third party statement is a statement by a supervisor or employer about the degree of competence they believe you have achieved. This can be based on observing your workplace performance, inspecting your work or gaining feedback from fellow workers.

Your trainer and/or assessor may use other methods to assess you such as:

- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Role plays
- Log books
- Group projects
- Practical demonstrations.

Remember your trainer is there to help you succeed and become competent. Please feel free to ask him or her for more explanation of what you have just read and of what is expected from you and best wishes for your future studies and future career in tourism and hospitality.

Unit descriptor

Plan, prepare and display a buffet service

This unit deals with the skills and knowledge required to Plan, prepare and display a buffet service in a range of settings within the hotel and travel industries workplace context.

Unit Code:

D1.HCC.CL2.07

Nominal Hours:

45 hours

Element 1: Plan a buffet display and service

Performance Criteria

- 1.1 Plan a buffet display and service appropriate to client needs
- 1.2 Plan layout, display and presentation of the buffet
- 1.3 Calculate quantities required and food costs components of buffet
- 1.4 Select appropriate food items
- 1.5 Identify and prepare a variety of buffet centre pieces

Element 2: Prepare and produce buffet dishes

Performance Criteria

- 2.1 Select appropriate preparation and cooking methods for dishes on buffet menu
- 2.2 Glaze buffet foods were appropriate
- 2.3 Hold prepared products as required prior to presenting
- 2.4 Prepare garnishes, sauces and accompaniments for appropriate buffet dishes
- 2.5 Use trimming and leftovers

Element 3: Display buffet dishes

Performance Criteria

- 3.1 Present buffet products
- 3.2 Hold prepared products as required for duration of buffet service
- 3.3 Minimise wastage through presentation and replenishing
- 3.4 Display buffet dishes attractively

Element 4: Store buffet items

Performance Criteria

- 4.1 Store fresh and or vacuum packed items correctly
- 4.2 Store buffet products appropriately in correct containers
- 4.3 Label stored buffet food correctly
- 4.4 Store in correct conditions to maintain freshness and quality

Assessment matrix

Showing mapping of Performance Criteria against Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions

The Assessment Matrix indicates three of the most common assessment activities your Assessor may use to assess your understanding of the content of this manual and your performance – Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions. It also indicates where you can find the subject content related to these assessment activities in the Trainee Manual (i.e. under which element or performance criteria). As explained in the Introduction, however, the assessors are free to choose which assessment activities are most suitable to best capture evidence of competency as they deem appropriate for individual students.

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
Element 1: Plan a buffet display and service				
1.1	Plan a buffet display and service appropriate to client needs	1.1	1, 2	1
1.2	Plan layout, display and presentation of the buffet	1.1	3, 4	2
1.3	Calculate quantities required and food costs components of buffet	1.2	5	3
1.4	Select appropriate food items	1.2	6, 7	4
1.5	Identify and prepare a variety of buffet centre pieces	1.3	8	5
Element 2: Prepare and produce buffet dishes				
2.1	Select appropriate preparation and cooking methods for dishes on buffet menu	2.1	9, 10	6
2.2	Glaze buffet foods were appropriate	2.2	11, 12	7
2.3	Hold prepared products as required prior to presenting	2.3	13, 14	8
2.4	Prepare garnishes, sauces and accompaniments for appropriate buffet dishes	2.4	15	9
2.5	Use trimming and leftovers	2.5	16	10
Element 3: Display buffet dishes				
3.1	Present buffet products	3.1	17	11
3.2	Hold prepared products as required for duration of buffet service	3.2	18, 19	12

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
3.3	Minimise wastage through presentation and replenishing	3.3	20, 21	13
3.4	Display buffet dishes attractively	3.4	22, 23	14
Element 4: Store buffet items				
4.1	Store fresh and or vacuum packed items correctly	4.1	24	15
4.2	Store buffet products appropriately in correct containers	4.2	25	16
4.3	Label stored buffet food correctly	4.3	26	17
4.4	Store in correct conditions to maintain freshness and quality	4.4	27	18

Glossary

Term	Explanation
Aromatics	Herbs, spices and strongly flavoured vegetables used to impart flavour into sauce or other food
Ballotine	Chicken leg boned and stuffed with a farce. Can be served hot or cold. Slice thinly.
Baste	Technique of brushing, spooning or pouring liquids over food. Especially roasts to preserve moisture.
Braise	Slow cook in container with lid inside an oven
Casserole	Casserole cooking is generally done in an oven to bake where heat circulates all around the cooking vessel. Casseroles may be cooked covered or uncovered. The word casserole is also used for the food cooked and served in such a vessel, with the cookware itself called a casserole dish or casserole pan.
Controlled Environment	Area where temperature is controlled; refrigerated coolroom; hot bain-marie; freezer
Cryovac	Brand name of machine used for vacuum packing of foods
Cutlet	Meat attached to the single bone of an animal
Entremets	Small food item served between courses in the old classical menu; ideal for buffet
Fillet	The tenderloin of beef, pork or lamb, or can refer to a boneless piece or even portion of fish, chicken
Foodstuff	Any food fit for human consumption
Frenched	Term used to describe fleshing meat from bone on cutlets. Also referred to as 'French cut'.
Galantine	Whole chicken boned and stuffed with a farce, cooked and covered in aspic or chaud froid before being carved and presented on platter
Ganache	A chocolate paste or filling made from boiling of cream and stirring it into chocolate
Gateau or Torte	Traditionally described as a cake or sponge soaked with syrup or liqueur and layered with fillings

Term	Explanation
Herbs	Aromatic leaves of plants that are used in cooking to impart flavour
High Risk Foods	Food that is not kept under temperature control may have abnormal growth of bacteria. Examples include cooked rice and pasta; cooked and raw meats poultry and seafood; dairy products; moist high protein foods
Holding equipment	Equipment used to hold food at a specific temperature of for short periods of time
Jellying Agent	An agent used to set (soft solid food), e.g. Gelatine, Agar-agar, Pectin
Joconde Sponge	A thin sponge sheet made from almond or marzipan paste.
Layout	How the room is set up; where the food is going to be and how the customers approach the food display
Low Risk Foods	Food that can sit at room temperature and not have bacterial growth
Marinate	Food is placed in flavoured acidic solution to tenderise and flavour a piece of food; normally meats, poultry and seafood
Muscle	Edible flesh of an animal
Salamander	Equipment used to grill foods with radiated heat
Seafood	Any live animal that comes from the water; seawater and freshwater
Shellfish	Seafood animals that have a hard shell on outside of body
Sieve	Fine mesh of wires that enable larger pieces of food to be captured and separated from smaller particles
Sirloin	Riblion of beef with bone removed
Standard Recipe	A recipe that produces a set number of dishes or required volume for a set number of persons
Steak	single portion of boneless meat, sometimes on the bone
Standard Recipe	A recipe that produces a set number of dishes or required volume for a set number of persons
Stew	Slow wet cooking method, usually for tough cuts of meat

Term	Explanation
Stock rotation	Using old stock before using new stock; when new stock is the be stored the old stock is taken off shelf
Terrine	Minced pork with lots of aromatics and flavouring gently poached in a form at a low temperature. When cooked they are pressed and chilled. It was a way of preserving meats keeping meats submerged under fat until required. Now popular as an entrée or as buffet foods. served with cheese bread and pickled foods
Vacuum packing	Food is placed into plastic bag and all air is extracted leaving low oxygen environment that allows food to be refrigerated longer rather than freezing. Has a tenderising effect on meats without loss of moisture

Element 1:

Plan a buffet display and service

1.1 Plan a buffet display and service appropriate to client needs

The term buffet refers to a variety of hot and cold food displayed for guest to choose from.

The buffet menu could be considered a table d'hôte menu however it differs in the way it is served to the customers.

Buffets have their origin in the magnificent displays of food that were a feature of court life in the eighteenth century. They reached a high point with the displays created by the famous French chef Antonin Careme and included spectacular displays of the food arts of ice, sugar and margarine carving.



The buffet menu has many practical advantages for serving large numbers of guests, and can be adapted to the needs of the customer for weddings, birthdays and special events. Generally buffets are informal in nature because they involve people moving about and serving themselves.

The buffet is often highly decorated with edible flowers and fruits in season. It may be enhanced with a centrepiece prepared by the cook or chef to show the customers the artistic skill of the kitchen staff.

The layout of the buffet food varies greatly depending on the following factors:

- The type of buffet
- The occasion
- The number of guests
- The dishes selected
- The style of service.

The buffet may be set on one long table or a number of smaller tables. Buffet style service plays a big part in the operation of “all day dining” restaurants in many large hotels.

The position of centrepieces should be decided first and then the dishes should be arranged in the order of the menu.

That is entree, hot and cold main courses, salads, desserts and cheeses.

It is essential to organise the buffet in a way that ensures good guest flow.

All the dishes must be readily accessible and close to the accompaniments and sauces.

Each buffet section is defined by a stack of plates to indicate the starting point and also indicates the direction the guests should flow.

One of the most important aspects of a buffet is to demonstrate, promote and maintain good hygiene practices throughout the entire life of the buffet.

This includes the preparation, cooking, presentation, service and cleaning procedures.

The fundamental rule is to keep cold items below 5°C and hot items above 60°C.

Disposable gloves should be used to handle the food and the cooking area should be kept spotlessly clean.

Remember the buffet food has to be a safe for the guests to eat as well as attractive for maximum visual appeal.



Buffet menu styles

There are several different styles of buffets, largely distinguished by the type of food served.

Almost any type of hot or cold can be served, with perhaps the exception of foods, which are best, served immediately, such as hot soufflés.

Classic buffet

A classic buffet refers to a style of food service where the food is lay out or displayed on a table.

A classic buffet is normally held for a dinner and would include a range of food from several courses of the menu, both hot and cold. It would also include a number of elaborate decorated pieces around which platters are arranged.

The guests may serve themselves or be served and will be seated at tables as per a normal dinner.

Cocktail buffet

A buffet maybe served at any time of an afternoon or early evening.

The food presented are small savoury items such as canapés, dips etc. Items should be no larger than two mouthfuls as guests are normally standing, drinking and talking whilst they are served.

Coffee and small pastries may also be served at a cocktail buffet.



Smorgasbord

Scandinavia is famous for its smorgasbord, which originated from the festive boards or tables laid out to celebrate the return of the victorious Vikings.

The food on a smorgasbord differs from that of a normal buffet both in style and presentation.

The foods used are traditionally Scandinavian (Sweden, Denmark, Finland and Norway) and include many varieties of: Herring and other seafood, pates, smallgoods, cheeses and salad.

Dishes maybe hot or cold. The foods are not decorated, but are simply laid out in the natural state. In fact a smorgasbord is more of a home style cooking.

Fork and finger buffet

The food for this type of buffet must be of a nature that allows a guest to stand using either fingers or a fork.

Small hors d'oeuvres, cheese, tartlets, wet dishes with rice and salads are all suitable.

This style of buffet may be served for lunch, afternoon refreshment, dinner or supper.

Breakfast buffet

A breakfast buffet is a popular feature in many hotels as an alternative to an a la carte breakfast service, and includes a wide variety of foods such as:

- Toast
- Croissants
- Waffles
- Eggs
- Sausages
- Chilled fruits
- Stewed fruits
- Cereals
- Coffee and tea.



The customer usually helps themselves, however a Chef may be present at the buffet to prepare omelettes and fried eggs etc. to order.

Brunch buffet

The word brunch is derived from breakfast and lunch and is usually served from 10.00 – 14.00. There are two menus styles; breakfast and lunch – combined into one.

It is quite common to start brunch with a glass of champagne, normally included in the price.

Carvery buffet

A Carvery buffet is usually served for lunch or dinner and includes a variety of hot carvings such as lamb, veal, pork, poultry, fish etc. which are displayed and carved on request of the customer:

- The table may be decorated with a bread or fruit display.

To accompany the carved items, vegetables, potatoes, salads, bread and appropriate condiments are added.

Theme buffet

A theme buffet can be any of the above types of buffets but is specifically planned and prepared using a theme for that particular occasion.

The following are some examples of theme buffets:

- Wedding
- Significant birthdays – 21st, 40th 50th etc.
- Religious festivals – Christmas, Easter, Ramadan
- Seasonal – Winter, spring, summer, autumn
- Major events – cultural or arts events
- Sporting event – Tennis, football etc.
- A particular cuisine:
 - Indian
 - Spanish
 - Chinese
 - Italian
 - A particular type of food – seafood.



The food, decorations and centrepieces would be selected based on the theme of the buffet.

For example: a wedding buffet would possibly use the wedding cake as the centre piece, the napkins and other linen would most likely match the colours of the bridal party as would the flowers and candles.



A seafood buffet could be called 'tastes of the sea' and use an ice carving of a dolphin as the centre piece.

Platters could also be carved from ice and used to present oysters, prawns and other cold seafood.

Often chocolate decorations are used for theme buffets:

- Some examples are chocolate tennis racquets and chocolate footballs.

They are used to decorate tables and to highlight the sporting theme of the event.

Variation in Buffet price

The major determining factor with any buffet is 'How much is the customer prepared to pay?'

The more the customer is prepared to pay the better the quality of the ingredients and the greater the variety on the menu.

Do not think that more food per person is required. People will only eat so much.

A professional chef will have several price point menus to fit most budgets.

1.2 Plan layout, display and presentation of the buffet

When planning the layout of the function consideration of where the function is to be delivered needs to be taken into account.

The shape of the room:

- Long narrow room
- Large square room
- Semi circular room
- Where are the windows?
- Is there a view?

Where will the buffet be held

- Inside an a dedicated food service venue
- Outside but at a dedicated hospitality venue
- Away from a dedicated hospitality venue but inside a building.
- Outside and away from a dedicated hospitality venue and building.
- What facilities are available where the function is going to be held?

All have to be considered.

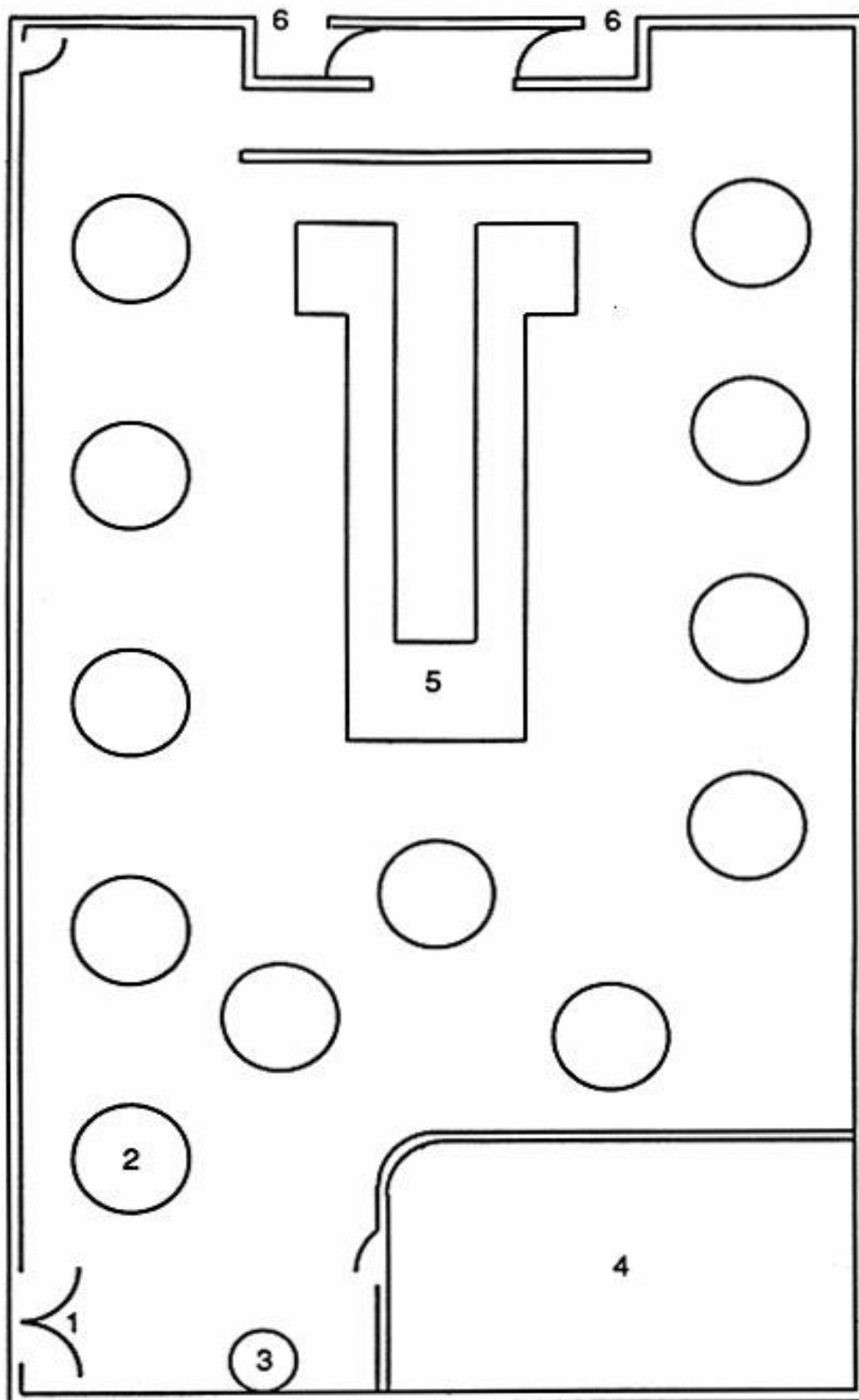
The layout will be controlled by the space available.

The important thing to keep in mind when planning the layout is flow:

- How easy will it be for the customers to view and select the food
- How easy is it for staff to monitor and replace food as required; access to food preparation area
- Ease of service for front of house requirements.
- The food display should not be obtrusive of any view, and the food display should be set back from this customer focal point.
- If the buffet is to be served outside by a swimming pool then display should be not near the water:
- Is there shade from the sun and protection from the wind
- Flowers displays do not last when it is too windy
- Is there protection from rain?

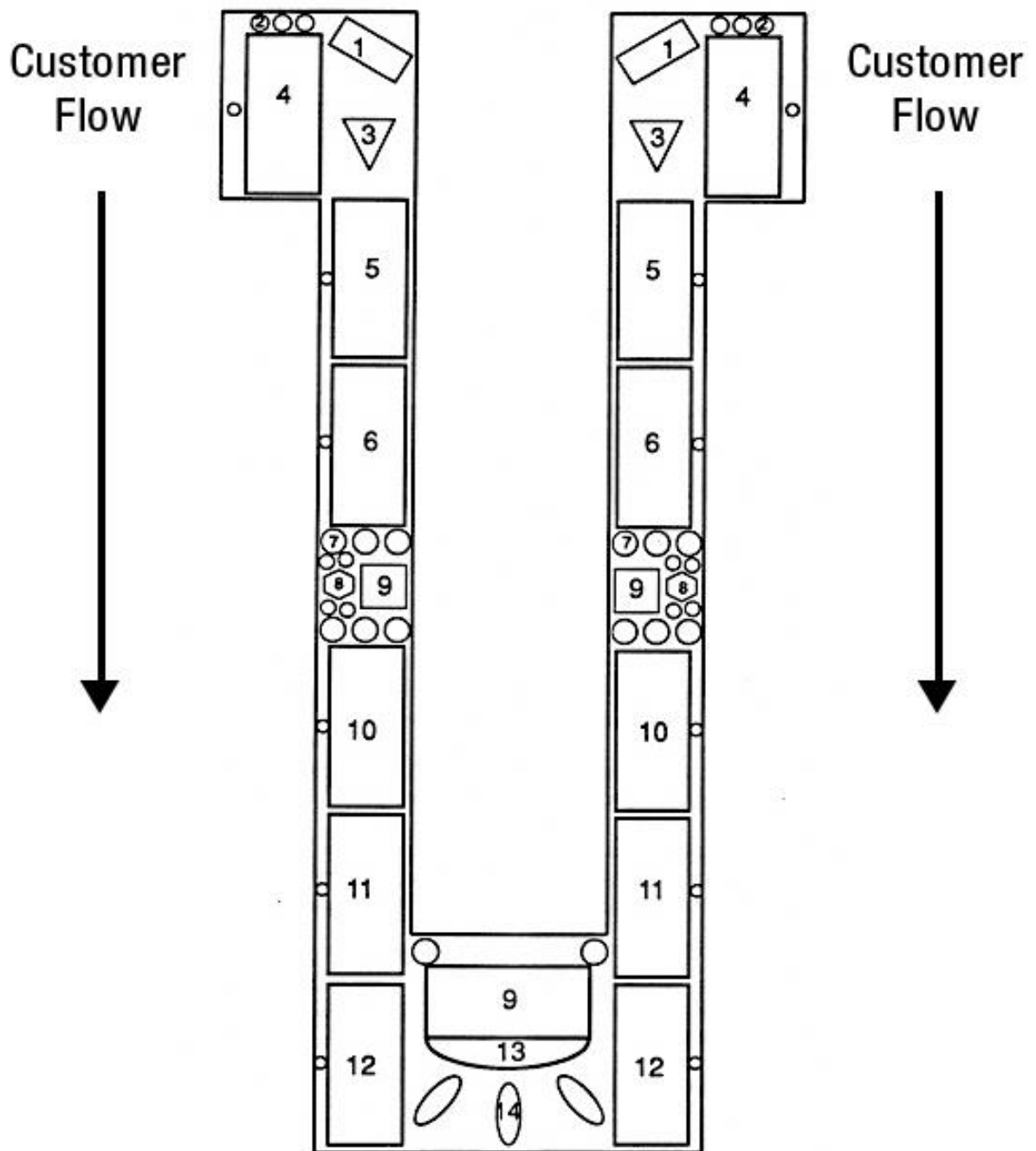


Example of a buffet layout plan



1. Guest entry	2. Guest table	3. Display table
4. Bar	Buffet table	6. Kitchen access

Table Plan



1. Butter	2. Plates	3. Bread Display	4. Charcuterie
5. Galantine (cold)	6. Seafood (cold)	7. Salads	8. Bread Rolls
9 Ice carving	10. Lamb (hot)	11. Turkey (hot)	12. Vegetarian (hot)
13. Fruit Display	14. Sauce Selection		

1.3 Calculate quantities required and food costs components of buffet

Portion control

The chef must be careful to avoid two common mistakes, which are:

- To prepare excessive quantities of food for the occasion
- To prepare more varieties of dishes than it is practical to present.

The maximum portion size should be half the size of an a la carte main course. Buffet portions should be small enough to allow the guest to sample a range of items.

The following are some portion control strategies:

- Get staff to serve the food
- Serve the entrée to the table
- Use the appropriate size service utensils that indicate the correct portion size
- Don't display too much food
- Pre-plate high cost items so that the guest will only take one plate.



For example plating can be used for expensive items so customers do not load up their plate with items like lobster and leave nothing for others.

Buffet menus are normally presented to the customers with a price per person and all the dishes are included.

The chef needs to be prepared with a variety of dishes that fit within a price structure.

This is all part of the professional management skills that cooks need to adopt to manage their kitchen costs.

What the chef needs is an up-to-date costing structure of ingredients for dishes that are being used.



Buffet portions can be as small as 40% of the size of a normal main course.

1.4 Select appropriate food items

The menu example

Buffet foods will have a wide selection choices:

- Hot dishes
- Cold dishes
- Salads
- Dessert or cakes and pastries
- Cheese.

Hot dishes

Hot food such as a simple roast or an aromatic lamb curry can be found on a wide variety of buffets.

Many hot dishes are suitable for buffets, some are quite simple to prepare such as a roast sirloin, whilst others such as sweet and sour pork are more elaborate.

In the past the choice of hot food found on a buffet tended to be very limited and most were meat dishes.

They also tended to be heavy in composition.

Today we have been influenced by a variety of cuisines from other countries and also by lifestyle choices.

Other cuisines; something that is not common within your own cuisine, for example:

- Mexican
- Moroccan
- Cajun
- Scandinavian
- Eastern European.

Life style choice: something that is not making a person unwell:

- **Vegetarian:** Non flesh eating; will eat egg and milk
- **Vegan:** Nothing from the animal; no milk, no egg.

Medical issues: Something that can cause a person to be unwell or possibly be fatal:

- Gluten intolerance
- Soy intolerance
- Seafood allergies
- Nut allergies.



Sauces

Sauces are generally lighter, there tend to be fewer meat based sauces, and more are made for use with vegetables, grains and pasta.

In general, the preparation of modern buffet dishes place more emphasis on short cooking times and nutritional value of the food.

The presentation of dishes is enhanced by a good variety of colours.

Roasted meats are always great idea for buffets and a selection of condiments would be on the side as well as a well flavoured sauce.

Salads on the buffet

Salads can be amongst the most colourful, flavoursome and eye-catching items on a buffet. The variety is almost endless.

They can be served warm or cold.

There are salads for almost every situation.

Dressings to accompany the salads also provide a great number of possibilities, as do the options for presentation.



Fruits and cheeses

Fruit and cheese arrangements may be included in a buffet.

Cheese is very popular in cold climate countries because they are home to dairy industries that supply milk. Cheese is a method of preserving milk as a food source.

Popular cheeses are:

- Soft:
 - Brie and Camembert
- Firm:
 - Cheddar, Tilsit and Edam
 - Washed rind cheese
- Blue cheese:
 - Gorgonzola, Stilton and Roquefort.



There are many other cheeses but for buffet you do not have to get very particular unless it is specified.

A Blue cheese, a cheddar cheese and a brie cheese with a selection of dried and fresh fruits represents a good cross section of varieties, flavours and textures.

Dessert or Sweet Menu items

When selecting sweets for presentation on a buffet table, you should ensure that the individual portions are uniform in size and appearance.

Gateaux tortes and flans should be marked in equal portion servings and be easy to cut:

- Tasteful decoration is essential for an attractive display.

Suitable buffet sweets include the following:

- Choux paste items: éclairs, swans and profiteroles
- Pastry items include: mille feuille items, palmiers and cream horns
- Entremets include: crème caramel, Bavaois, mousses and strawberry baskets.



Bread Show pieces

Breads and other display dough's such as salt dough and bread plaque dough can be moulded into a variety of shapes to provide showpieces for buffets.

The dough needs to be made very stiff so that it remains the shape into which it is moulded.

Products can also be coloured to provide more interest.

The bread show piece is not for consumption. Show pieces are designed to add interest to the table and showcase the skill of the people working in the establishments.



An example of a buffet menu

Western Buffet

Entrees

Hot

- Creamy vegetable pie
- Soup of the day
- Pasta of the day
- Hot mezzo i.e. marinated chicken wings, meatballs, spinach triangles etc.



Cold Food

- Antipasto platters;
- Seafood salad
- Chicken galantine (Sliced and aspic coated)
- Meat loaf (sliced)
- Terrine of Grilled vegetables.



Mains

- Moussaka or lasagne
- A fish or seafood dish
- Chicken tagine with cous cous
- Lamb kofta and rice pilaf
- Roast of the day - lamb, beef, and chicken
- Sweet and sour pork
- Vegetables; selection of hot
- Roast potatoes, sweet potatoes
- Sauces.



Salads	Dressings
Potato and egg salad Mixed lettuce Beetroot and orange salad Coleslaw Tomato, onion and basil Rice or Pasta	Mayonnaise Herb dressing Red capsicum relish Chutney
Sweet Dishes	Sauces
Baked cheesecake Chocolate mudcake Fruit pie Bavarois Crème caramel Pannacotta Summer pudding Pavlova Trifle Tira mi su Fresh fruit platter	Sauce anglaise Chocolate sauces Fruit coulis Caramel sauce Whipped cream Pouring cream

Indian buffet

Menu courses

Appetisers

The Indian banquet usually commences with appetisers, which are served before the main meal is served. The appetisers are usually both vegetarian and non vegetarian to cater to all guests.

Main course

The main course meal usually contains four to five vegetable dishes, different types of daals, pulao and breads. This is complimented with various salads and other condiments.

It also comprises of both vegetarian and non vegetarian dishes. The meal is the heaviest and grandest of all and showcases the best delicacies of any cuisine.



Desserts

After the primary meal is over, the guests are treated with desserts. Desserts are sweet items, which are served to ease the spicy and tingling taste of the meal.

Menu items

APPETISERS

Vegetarian

- Kesari paneer tikka
- Tulsi malai Paneer tikka
- Makkai meethi ki seekh
- Subz seekh kebab
- Dhaniya pudina tawa aloo
- Karwari mushroom
- Palak aur channe ki shammi
- Mushroom & cheese kurkure
- Bhune pyaaz aur makkai kurkure
- Bhutta Amritsar
- Smoked eggplant and halumi crostini with tahina dollop.



Non vegetarian

- Dakshini murg tikka
- Chicken tikka mirch masala
- Smoked chicken and black olive kebab
- Thyme crusted chicken fingers with garlic mayo
- Barbequed chicken
- Lasooni Lamb seekh kebab
- Shikhampuri kebab
- Til aur besan wali machli finger
- Rawa fried machili
- Machli sarson tikka



MAINS

Vegetarian

- Paneer butter masala
- Paneer lababdar
- Kadhai paneer
- Laccha paneer palak
- Malai kofta
- Bhuna hara saag
- Pindi chole
- Navrattan korma
- Bhutta do pyazz
- Aloo simla mirch
- Dum aloo banarasi
- Baingan aur mirch ka salan
- Bhindi aamchoori
- Dahi bhindi
- Dum ka phool
- Vegetable Jalfrezi
- Dhingri mutter.



Non Vegetarian

Lamb:

- Bhuna gosht
- Mutton coconut masala – south Indian style
- Rara gosht
- Handi gosht
- Pudina gosht korma
- *Chicken*
- Chicken makhani
- Dum ka murg
- Kadhai murg
- Kozhi Melagu – south Indian style
- Honey Roast chicken with thyme jus, flashed cherry tomato
- Barbeque chicken with caramelized pineapple
- Grilled chicken breast with garlic jus and buttered asparagus.



Fish:

- Goan fish curry
- Hariyali machli curry
- Malbari fried fish – south Indian style
- Oven baked fish with rosemary cream and balsamic infused pearl onion
- Pan seared fish with caper beurre blanc and grilled palm hearts.

Dal

- Dal Makhni
- Lasooni dal tadka
- Dal Panchmel
- Channa Dal palak.

Biryani

- Subz handi biryani
- Dum murgh biryani
- Kacche gosht ki biryani.

Rice / Pillaf

- Kaju kismis ka pulao
- Mutter Pulao
- Tomato bhat
- Gobi ki tehri
- Choliya pulao
- Steam rice.

**Accompaniments**

- Assorted Indian bread (Roti / Naan / Paratha / Missi roti).

**DESSERTS**Mithai

- Angoori rasmalai
- Kesari rasmalai
- Rasogulla
- Elaichi Shrikhand
- Kesar phirni
- Moong dal halwa
- Gajjar ka halwa
- Doodhi ka halwa
- Gulab jamun
- Marble gulab jamoon
- Kala jamoon
- Jalebi with rabdi
- Semiya ki kheer
- Malpua with rabdi.



Student Activity

The instructor has a selection of cuisines that student can choose.

Students are to research these cuisines and to develop recipes for 10 people:

- 3 dishes suitable for entrée
 - 3 main course dishes with all accompaniments
 - 3 desserts with sauces and separate garnishes for each dish.
-

1.5 Identify and prepare a variety of buffet centre pieces

What is a buffet Centrepiece?

It is the main decoration placed on the table to enhance the theme and presentation of the buffet.

It is generally large and the customer's eye is drawn to it and is of an edible nature.

What are buffet table decorations?

These are usually smaller in nature, but still should be of edible nature and can be very simple to enhance your presentation.

What is the difference between centre piece and table decorations?

Usually centrepieces are large and stand out on the table, which would blend in with the theme of the buffet:

- Table decorations are usually smaller but should still be of an edible nature
- Use culinary herbs and edible flowers so that will not go limp too quickly.

For example rosemary stems and bay leaf branches.

What is done by front of house (FOH) and not by the cooks!

Tablecloths, ribbons, napkins etc. would come under the FOH job tasks with the theme being presented.

Specific theme decorations are handled by FOH.

Buffets are a team effort. Table set up belongs to front of house staff while the kitchen fills the table with foods and display produce.

Need for artistic skills

Regardless of who is in charge of designing or setting up centrepieces or decorations it is essential that the person has suitable artistic skills to ensure the decoration:

- Reflects the theme
- Is suitable
- Is made up of correct materials and colours
- Is correctly placed and sized
- Does not impact on the quality of food items
- Remains in suitable condition or quality during the life of the buffet



Examples of buffet centre pieces:

- Most of these can be also used as smaller table decorations:
- Flower arrangements
- Ice carving
- Ice modellings – (Frozen in moulds)
- Margarine moulding/Fat carvings
- Blown /pulled /poured sugar
- Pastillage modelling
- Plastic icing modelling – flowers etc.
- Lump sugar building
- Royal icing run-outs and flowers
- Marzipan modelling
- Bee's wax modelling
- Chocolate modelling/moulding
- Chocolate carving
- Special occasion cakes/Gingerbread houses
- Painted edible pictures
- Block salt carving
- Vegetable/pumpkin carving
- Watermelon and fruit carving
- Salt bread dough modelling (sheaf of wheat Easter theme)
- Vegetable flowers and pumpkin carved flower vase.



Many buffet centrepieces are the domain of cooks with artistic skill. Many larger establishments can afford to employ people just to produce carvings and centrepieces.

These need to be well looked after as with time they tend to get damaged or if they have not been stored correctly dirty and dusty.

They are valuable items that need to be cared for correctly.

If buffets are done on an irregular basis then a fresh flower centrepiece might be the best option.

Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer.

You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project by the date agreed with your Trainer.

Buffet take planning; so the student must plan for buffet in many ways.

1.1 Plan a buffet display:

- Students may need to submit several theme designs
- Your trainer may vary this requirements
- The layout may be determined by the themes and where the buffet is to be served.

1.2. Select appropriate foods:

- Students will need to develop a number of menus for the customers to choose the buffet selection
- Students must research for menu ideas and develop recipes for 10 persons.
- This makes it easier to plan for greater numbers
- Portion sizes for buffet will be smaller
- What is the cost of the dish?
- Buffet price and a la carte price will be different.

1.3. Identify and select a variety of buffet centrepieces:

- Several centrepieces may be needed for the whole buffet
- Main display based on theme
- This should be the largest centrepiece display
- Dessert table
- This can be off to side so will need decoration on table
- Ice carvings do not last in warm climates unless they are in air conditioned rooms.

Summary

Plan a buffet display and service

Plan a buffet display and service appropriate to client needs

- Why does the client want a buffet?
 - Birthday
 - Wedding
 - Business function
- All needs to be considered before taking the client through the booking process
- Can you deliver what the client requires?

Plan layout, display and presentation of the buffet

- Each venue will have its own difficulties. Is the buffet inside or out by the pool.
- How far from the kitchen is the point of service?
- Is there cover to display the food?

Calculate quantities required and food costs components of buffet

- Buffet pricing tends to be so many dollars per person
- People will have more variety on their plate than a la carte
- Some people will over load their plate and some will not
- Feeding football team of young men will be different to feeding a ladies club gathering.

Select appropriate food items

- A wide variety should be on the menu from which the customer to choose
- A buffet should include hot food and cold foods with accompanying sauces
- Is it to be a sit down buffet or finger food buffet where people use small plates.

Identify and prepare a variety of buffet centre pieces

- Flowers are the most common table centrepiece. Availability will change due to seasons and this will need to be in the planning before the customer gets involved
- A lot of this is done by the Front of House crew
- Food themes centrepieces are the responsibility of the kitchen
- Margarine modelling can be popular but a specialist person needs to be employed to produce these
- Chocolate models sit well on the dessert table to add interest and attract the eyes of the customers
- Bread displays can be static; meaning the bread is modelled and is not for human consumption or a wide variety can be displayed that the customer can choose to eat with their food selection
- Savoury and sweet breads can be produced for this purpose.

Element 2: Prepare and produce buffet dishes

2.1 Select appropriate preparation and cooking methods for dishes on buffet menu

Buffet cooking will have a wide variety of foods and the method of cooking required will be dependant of the recipe.

The theme will also impact on the way the majority of food is cooked.

BBQ's tend not to have much steamed foods unless the food is encased in banana leaf and grill over hot coals which in fact steams the food.

Typically buffet will have the following cooking methods.

Roast: meat and vegetables; roast meat will be carved to customers request and will be one of the busiest service points.

Grilled: BBQ's are renowned for this, especially if it is outside.

Braise or Stewed: wet dishes are ideal for pre-cooking or pre-preparation.

Boiled: pasta and potatoes will be cooked then chilled for use in salads.

Baked: desserts and savoury pastry items will be baked.

Steaming and Deep Frying tend not to be included in buffet unless the process is specially requested.

Cooking for buffet is carried out away from the customer to avoid accidents. Buffet is the presentation and service point for the food.

It can be specialist service included in the theme so allowances will need to be made regarding equipment and persons to carry out specialist function.

Method of cooking can be limited the style but when all the foods are taken into account most methods of cookery will be used:

- Hot foods
- Chilled foods
- Room temperature foods.
- Keep the variety in the buffet and all methods will be required.



2.2 Glaze buffet foods were appropriate

Aspic

Aspic is a savoury jelly and used to glaze cold fish, meat, poultry, vegetables and pates.

There are a number of good quality types of convenience aspic available.

Aspic should be clear, free from apparent impurities, have no undissolved aspic crystals, and not be tough when set.

Chaud froid

The translation of the word is hot-cold.

This means that the sauce is made hot and used only when cold.

The sauce is used to give a smooth shiny surface to the food upon which a decoration is placed. The sauce is prepared and cooled until it reaches a coating consistency.

The item to be coated is cooked, cooled, trimmed and then covered. Aspic is made by adding aspic to a base sauce.

There are two main types; white which is made from chicken, veal or fish veloute and brown which is made from demi-glaze.

Glazing of desserts

Glazing is applied to surfaces that will show signs of drying when exposed to the open air after a few hours:

- Fruits on pastries
- Baked sweet flans
- Cheesecakes.

All these will dry on surface when exposed to air. Even in coolroom so glazes are applied to stop this drying and turning the edges shrivelled.

Gel also adds to the appeal and reflects the light and gives moisture in the mouth when eating.

In the case of roast meats, once they have been placed onto the plate the customer can be offered a sauce or a glaze to accompany the meat.



2.3 Hold prepared products as required prior to presenting

The dish is cooked. When is the dish going to be served?

Is the dish going to be served hot or cold?

Hot food

To keep food hot until the customers are ready to eat is a challenge in establishments everywhere:

- To keep food hot establishments would use a 'Bain-Maire'
- A bain-marie is a bench well that is normally filled with water.

This water is heated to at least 80°C and the food is placed into trays that fit into the special grooves in the bench.



These trays of food are then suspended over the hot water and this will keep the food hot until the customers are ready to eat.

Food that is placed into a bain-marie for 'hot' holding must be hot, above 75°C, before being put into the 'Bain-Marie'.

If the food is not hot then the food will lose heat and customer dissatisfaction will prevail:

- Hot food should not be 'held' in a bain-marie for more than 1 hour
- Food will begin to dry out and quality will drop.

If food is allowed to drop below 60°C it will enter the 'danger zone' and bacterial growth might begin. If food is in the danger zone for more than 4 hours it must be thrown away and not be chilled and used at a later date.

Each tray of food in a bain-marie should have its own set of serving utensils. This reduces the possibility of 'cross-contamination' in the foods.

Each tray of food in the bain-marie should be covered with a lid to protect the food.

Cold Foods

Unless all the food is cooked from scratch then it will need to be cooled and held at a temperature that will not allow for bacterial growth.

All cooked foods should be held at a temperature less than 5°C for no more than 3-4 days.

When being held at this temperature the foods must be protected from contamination from outside sources.



The food must be secured in a container either with a lid or covered with plastic wrap. This food must also have a label attached identifying the food and when it was made and who made the food.

2.4 Prepare garnishes, sauces and accompaniments for appropriate buffet dishes

Introduction

Sauces and Condiments

Sauces and garnishes must be arranged according to enterprise standards for specific dishes.

Precisely what these standards are will depend on the nature of the premises – there are a wide variety of standards to choose from and very little that is absolutely 'right' or absolutely 'wrong'.

They are all personal/establishment preferences dictated by tradition, personal wishes, experimentation, cultural influence or a combination of all these things.

Accompaniments will add contrast to the meat dish as well as compliment the type of meat being cooked.

Accompaniments include:

- **Sauces:** flavoured to compliment the type of meat cooked
- **Garnishes:** chopped herbs to add flavour and colour to the dish
- **Vegetables:** the variety of preparations are endless, boiled, roasted, hot, cold.

Care taken to prepare accompaniments must be as careful as the preparations of the meat dish itself.



Major points to remember are:

- Sauces and garnishes are the finishing touches to a meal – they provide the visual stimulation which heightens the enjoyment of many dishes
- Eye appeal is buy appeal – if the food looks attractive then guest anticipation of great flavour is aroused
- If the meal looks depressing, uninteresting and unattractive then customers will tend to be more critical and will enjoy their meal less even though it may taste exactly the same.



There is unlikely to be a meal session where at least one sauce is not made, or available for service.

Sauces are integral part of many dishes, whilst in other instances they are added simply to supplement what is already there.

Their role can be seen as to provide colour, flavour and interest to the dish.

Sauces may be categorised as follows:

- Hot sauces – They may be created entirely in-house from fresh ingredients, ‘Jus’ or prepared from proprietary convenience foods (beef booster, demi-glace powder and stock powder), or be some unique combination of both. Examples of these include Espagnole, Veloute, Béchamel and their derivatives, also included are ‘gravies’
- Warm emulsions - such as Hollandaise Sauce and Sauce Béarnaise – based on a combination of egg yolks, oil and vinegar
- Condiments such as mustards, pickles, chutney can also be served beside meat dishes
- Cold sauces or dressings, which are described on the next page.

Edible garnishes

Most garnishes are edible. They usually consist of fruit and vegetable, sometime flowers or their petals:

- The vegetable can be cut into shapes and presented on side of plates
- Fresh herb leaves are very popular for their flavour and contrasting green colour
- Flower petals are used for visual appeal
- Slices and segments of fruit make nice contrast to meals.



It will usually be the chef who decides what garnishes should be used with what dishes, and considerations include:

- Cost – the cost of ingredients is always a consideration, and a less expensive alternative is frequently attractive
- Preparation time – this is definitely related to cost but factors in labour to produce the garnish. Carved garnishes, whilst attractive and spectacular, can become prohibitive when the time taken in creating them is factored in
- Keeping qualities – being able to prepare garnishes in advance is preferable so as to speed up final service, but if the garnishes lose their visual appeal over-time then they may be unacceptable:
 - The garnishes must look fresh and appetising when served, not dull, tired and stale
- Contrast with the food item – some staff are used in order to provide a colour or taste contrast with the main dish
- Complimentary qualities – this is a variation of the ‘contrast’ approach. The idea here is the garnish fits in with the overall taste of the main item – it ‘echoes’ a primary ingredient
- For example, if mint were used in the Hamburger Deluxe, then a sprig of mint may be appropriate as the garnish; if rosemary was used in the roast lamb, then a sprig of rosemary may be suitable as a garnish
- Continuation of a theme – where the main dish used a variety of salad vegetables, then the use of another unused salad vegetable as a garnish will continue the established theme, providing an attractive finish to the overall presentation.

Garnishes are prepared as part of your normal mise-en-place:

- Herbs can be chopped to sprinkle over top of finished salad for flavour and eye appeal
- Herb sprigs can be used to decorate top of salads
- Thin slices of vegetables: julienne of carrot, slivers of spring onion
- Nuts, roasted and chopped to add flavour
- Fried bread pieces or Oven roasted
- Deep fried shaving of vegetables.

Accompaniments

Sauces and/or dressings

Dressings can be classified into two types:

- Vinegar based
- Mayonnaise based.

Vinaigrette based sauces can be value added:

- French
- Roquefort, blue cheese added to vinaigrette

Or other flavour added to base dressing.

Mayonnaise based dressing:

- Caesar dressing.

Holding and storage conditions

- Salads with leaves and herbs will not hold well after the dressing has been applied
- Vinegar will cause the leaves to wilt. Do not dress the salads too soon
- Salads can be mixed then stored. Do not dress then store
- Salads leaves have a short lifespan.

Cutting techniques, size and shape.

As cultural diversity comes into the menu so will the expectation of preparation styles.

Many Asian styles will incorporate intricate styles of cutting.



Some special tools are available to replicate this in the modern world but with higher wage costs outside of the Asian region it becomes unviable to do this elaborate vegetable carving.

Modern machines will now do the bulk of large scale dicing and slicing.

2.5 Use trimming and leftovers

When preparing dishes and off cuts and trimmings can be utilised in the production kitchen.

Leftovers from the buffet can be utilised in other areas if they have not been outside of the control of the kitchen.

If the dish has been placed onto the buffet table, left untouched and then returned to the kitchen then is cannot be utilised at a later time:

- It must be discarded.

When cooked dishes have been placed onto the buffet table it has left control of the kitchen so therefore the integrity of the dish cannot be guaranteed.

When preparing the dishes any trimmings should be used for other menu items or staff meals at a later date. Within two days.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer.

You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project by the date agreed with your Trainer.

Buffet take planning; so the student must plan for buffet in many ways.

2.1 Select menu items that have a wide variety of cooking styles:

- Define the selection of customers requests
- The menu offered should have had a wide selection imbedded.

2.2. Glaze foods where appropriate:

- Glaze food where required to prevent drying and enhance visual appeal.

2.3. Hold foods as required before serving:

- Hot foods need to be held hot and cold foods need to be chilled until required.

2.4. Prepare and selection of garnishes to match the dishes being served:

- Garnishes need to compliment the dishes with which they are being served
- Garnishes need to be varied.

2.5. Use leftovers:

- Leftovers need to be discarded after buffet has been served
 - If the food has left controlled storage and been placed onto the buffet it does not go back into storage in the kitchen.
-

Summary

Prepare and produce buffet dishes

Select appropriate preparation and cooking methods for dishes on buffet menu

- A broad range of cookery methods will be implemented within the menu items chosen
- It will not be all deep fried or all boiled.

Glaze buffet foods where appropriate

- Glazing adds eye appeal to foods and the added moisture improves the eat ability of the dish.

Hold prepared products as required prior to presenting

- Hot foods need to be held above 60°C
- Cold foods need to be held below 5°C.

Prepare garnishes, sauces and accompaniments for appropriate buffet dishes

- Garnishes should complement the food with which they are being served
- They should be fresh
- There should be a variety:
 - Chopped herbs
 - Grated cheese
 - Croutons
- Sauces can be served with the dish or on the side
- A variety of Accompaniments will also be produced and presented with the buffet dishes.

Element 3: Display buffet dishes

3.1 Present buffet products

One of the most important steps when setting up a buffet for service is to ensure that the tables are set up to meet the requirements of the upcoming buffet.

Whilst food is the main component of a buffet, there is quite a number of items that need to be placed on different areas of a buffet, each serving a very important purpose.

In addition, the buffet tables must be aesthetically pleasing as it places a large role in the overall decoration of a room.

Knowledge of staff setting up buffets

It is essential that staff, be it kitchen or service staff, involved in the set up of a buffet have enough knowledge to understand:

- Policies and procedures for setting up buffets
- How they should be set up
- What menu items are to be served
- How they are to be served
- What crockery, cutlery or glassware is required
- What service ware is required
- What holding equipment is required
- Decorations or accompaniments
- Signs that are needed to identify food items
- An understanding of the ingredients of menu items to ensure any customer enquiries can be answered accurately



Importance of professional table settings

The presentation of a buffet table says a lot to customers about the level of service they can expect to receive in an establishment.

A great deal of work and attention to detail must be applied when setting buffet tables, as they must:

- Have all the necessary service crockery, cutlery, centrepieces, decorations and condiments, to name but a few items
- Must be complete
- Must be clean and hygienic
- Must be uniform and consistent throughout the outlet

By ensuring that the buffet table has all the necessary items that the customer may need, not only makes kitchen and service staff roles easier during service, but ensures that customers are not left waiting for items that should be close at hand.

Due to the nature of buffet menu items, there may be many items that accompany them. This does not mean that everything is expected to be placed on the table. In order to assure the comfort of customers, items may need to be prepared and placed away from the table in a suitable location.

Dressing tables

On special occasions, or as part of standard operating procedures, buffet tables may need to be dressed.

Dressing takes place as part of the set up and enhances presentation of the table.

It is time consuming, and frequently requires additional items to be used, so it is an uncommon activity, rather than a common one.



Boxing tables

Tables can be boxed to enhance their appearance.

It is usual to box buffet tables at functions.

Boxing involves folding a table cloth around the vertical fall of the table so that the sides of the table and the legs are hidden from view.

Many establishments have specially prepared (pleated or plain) boxing sheets that are simply held in place with drawing pins, or fitted exactly to the size of individual tables.



Presentation

Height

A very important factor to remember in buffet presentation is the height of dishes.

Try always to present the food at different levels, not only on the table, but also on different levels on the individual platters.

This is achieved by using different socles or by building up arrangements of sliced food to improve presentation.

Socles are moulded, edible bases used to elevate and present food for cold buffet items.

It can be made with ice (caviar), deep fried bread (roasted wild birds and lobster), rice which is suitable for most presentations.

The platters

Everything on the plate or platter should be edible. Avoid the use of materials that you know the customer cannot eat.

If a platter is to be highly decorated, use a small centrepiece or corner piece to lift the platter.

The item used, as the decoration must be prepared entirely from normally edible materials, such as socles made from bread or flowers cut from various vegetables to form a vase.



Catching the customer's eye

The object of decorating food is to catch the customer's eye and make the dish appealing.

However, always remember that the primary purpose of the buffet is for the food to be eaten and therefore the decoration must never be considered more important than the taste of the food.



Decorations

The art of decorating any food is to present the decorated dish as simply as possible.

Many a dish has been spoilt due to the inability of the cook to stop at the right time.

Inexperienced cooks have the urge to keep putting on more garnish than necessary and in the end present an unbalanced and over decorated meal.

When decorating, consider the size of the decoration in relation to the size of the food to be decorated.

It must be neither too large nor too small. The lines of the decoration should enhance and follow the natural contours of the dish.

The decoration should not be heavy or thick. Simple design is usually not only easier to prepare and present, but it also reduces the time needed for preparation.

The decoration chosen should in some way relate to the food decorated. Avoid unsuitable clashes where decoration is not normally accepted as an accompaniment to the food decorated.

Clean presentation. The dish decorated should be clean in presentation, not overcrowded in any way, and free from finger marks or unnecessary garnishing.

Plenty of room should be allowed on the dish, so that the removal of part of the food does not affect the general visual impression of the dish.

A well-presented buffet dish has a good visual impact even after a number of portions have been served. Never place garnish or decoration in the very edge or rim of the platter.

In selecting the garnish or decoration, always use natural colours or natural foods to decorate. Colour should be bright but not gaudy.

The most common colours for food decorations are black, red, green, and white, and should be obtained from the use of natural foods.

It is a generally accepted principle that blue is avoided in food decoration, the exception being on certain sweet items.

The flavour of the garnish must be considered and must either be the same as the main or be recognized as a suitable flavour to enhance the main item.



3.2 Hold prepared products as required for duration of buffet service

Introduction

Holding prepared products before service can be applied to two areas:

- Hot food
- Cold food.

Holding prepared cooked food requires food to be held at temperatures above 60°C until it is served to customers.

Holding food cold at safe temperature until required for service requires that food be held at temperature of less than 5°C until required.

If food is outside of this temperature control range for more than two hours, it must be immediately consumed or else discarded. It must not be kept for service at another time.

To hold foods above 60°C the bain-marie must be operating at 80°C and the food must be covered.

If the bain-marie is not operating at this temperature then the food will not be at above 60°C and the process will have to be rectified.

The food at the end of the buffet service needs to be as good as the food at the beginning.

When buffet food is platter it must be stored and protected from damage by being stored away from normal kitchen traffic. Store on specific trolley wrapped to protect from drying in coolroom and from being knocked out of placement.



3.3 Minimise wastage through presentation and replenishing

Minimize wastage should include during a buffet comes down to planning and proper management.

Management decision need to be made regarding:

- The size of the presentation platter that will be use
- How much food will be on the platter or plates?
- At what stage will these platter or plates be replaced?

Food Hygiene

The ethics of good food hygiene require that all food that has been placed out into the buffet function service area is not to be used for other purposes after it has been removed from the buffet.

Buffet platters should not be replenished; they should be replaced with food of the same quality on fresh platters..

Storage space

When preparing food for buffet it must be stored correctly until it is to be served.

It is not possible to purchase, prepare, process, cook and serve all the buffet food within the 4 hour period that defines good food hygiene.

Portion control

Buffet portion should be smaller than a la carte serves.

A la carte serving for 10 could translate to 20 or 25 serves for buffet.

Many buffets can be considered sampling serves.

Use platter or plates that will allow for the majority of the prepared food to be used for the buffet.

This increases profit margins and is good management.

First In, First Out (FIFO)

When preparing food over long periods it is good practice to use the food that has been in your custody before using the last food purchased.

Replenishing times, as needed.

Replenishing platters on a buffet means to replace them with new platter or plates of the same food or of equal value.

You are not allowed to 'top up' the old platters with fresh foods. Control of food safety is lost when this practice is implemented.

'Topping up' is when fresh food is placed on top of food already on the buffet. This is not an acceptable practice.



3.4 Display buffet dishes attractively

Buffet displays need to be pleasant and appealing the eye of the consumers.

Colour

Colours are used to stimulate the senses:

- Shiny reflective surfaces of the serving equipment
- Shine of the sauces and gels covering the foods
- Colour of the sauces and gels.



Colours

- Reds
- Greens
- Yellow.

These are the colours of garnishes:

- Green herbs
- Julienne of red and yellow capsicum.

Colour in Fresh Fruit Salads:

- Red strawberries
- Orange cantaloupe
- Green grapes
- Dark red strawberries
- Black and white of the Dragon fruit
- Red and black of the Dragon fruit
- Banana flesh
- Black and green of the kiwi fruit
- Gold and black of the passionfruit.



Colours stimulate the senses of the customers to make the food seem appealing.

Use a variety of colour around the display, mix them up.



Types of food

Hot foods

Food being served hot will have to have special equipment to keep these foods hot.

This equipment will have to be very clean on the outside as well as the inside.

When customers approach a buffet and see tarnished metal when it should be polished it makes a bad image for the company presenting the buffet.

These hot foods need to be in a section on their own because each.



Room temperature foods

Room temperature foods can be displayed out on the open table. Some foods will improve in taste when allowed to be served at room temperature.

Again the use of colour makes the food more appealing to the consumers.



Chilled foods

Foods that are served cold can be placed into a position without refrigeration if the food is monitored for time.

Food cannot sit at room temperature for more than 4 hours. If the food has been out of controlled atmosphere for that length of time it must be thrown away.

Good buffet management by staff will not have food out for more than 1 hour without being changed.

If the food is expected to be eaten chilled then a refrigerated display needs to be displayed.

Shape and size of the platters and bowls

- Rectangular
- Square
- Oval
- Triangular.

The shape of the platter adds interest to the display.

Be sure that design you choose is going to be there in 6 months time when breakages need to be replaced.



Many function houses end up with a mixture of designs and shapes.

How deep?

When does a platter become a bowl?

Platters are for the display of foods that do not have any liquid component. Sauces can be added later or is served on the side.

A bowl needs to be deep enough to contain any liquid portion of the dish from spilling out onto the table.

Flow

Flow of customers

The customers must be easily able to approach the display and see the presentation from a distance.

Separate the dessert from the main buffet.

Separate the hot food from the cold food.

Flow of food

Back to front of the table

- Allows the presentation to fall towards the customers.

Higher at the back than the front

- Food at the back of the table should be slightly higher than the food near the front of the buffet table.

Customer must be able to easily reach the food

- If the customers have to reach over other foods to get from that more appealing food at the back they may contaminate the food near the front with their clothing
- Drop food from the back of the display into food near the back of the display.

Can the kitchen come access the buffet without going through the customers?

Access to the display for the kitchen staff replacing foods needs to be considered when setting up the buffet.

Trying to walk through the guests with hot food can be a recipe for disaster:

- Injury to the guest with hot food
- Damage to their clothing
- Loss of the food being carried
- Injury to staff.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer.

You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project by the date agreed with your Trainer.

Buffet take planning; so the student must plan for buffet in many ways.

3.1 Hold prepared products:

- When the menu items have been prepared then they must be held at the appropriate temperature until they are required
- Explain in your plan how you will accomplish this target
- Define the parameters that must be met to accomplish this task.

3.2. Present buffet products:

- Describe how each menu item is to be displayed.
- When the menu item is developed a picture can be used next to the standard recipe to show how it is expected to be presented.

3.3. Minimise wastage:

- When serving it is good to have different size plates and platters for the flow of the buffet
- As it slows down smaller platters can be used so less food is out on display but still giving variety.

3.4. Display buffet so it is attractive to the eye:

- When displaying buffet items they can on different size platters, different shape for different foods
 - Have elevated bases that platters can be placed on to give them different heights
 - Remember, people have to be able to reach the food.
-

Summary

Display buffet dishes

Present buffet products

- When presenting buffet products it must be balanced when placed onto the platter.
- Do not overload with too much product:
 - Single items like fruit tarts need to be lined up in rows.

Hold prepared products as required for duration of buffet service

- Keep foods in the condition that they are meant to be eaten:
 - Hot
 - Cold
 - Room temperature
- This all matches the eating sensation and overall enjoyment of the meal.

Minimise wastage through presentation and replenishing

- Use multiple size platter and serving utensils
- Large for the busy times
- Smaller towards the end of the buffet
- Have a start and finish time for food service.

Display buffet dishes attractively

- When displaying buffet items they can on different size platters, different shape for different foods
- Have elevated bases that platters can be placed on to give them different heights
- Remember, people have to be able to reach the food.

Element 4: Store buffet items

4.1 Store fresh and or vacuum packed items correctly

Vacuum packaging

Cryovac; vak pak; are brand names that use the system of vacuum packing foods.

Vacuum packing is a system by which food is placed in special plastic bags and all the air is then withdrawn using a special machine, which then heat seals the bag.

Meat packaged this way is normally stored at minus one degree to zero degrees Celsius (-1°-0°). This extends the storage life of the meat. Note that poultry should only be stored this way for up to two weeks.

Red meat should be stored in single layers, fat side up, on a tray.

Note: Sometimes after long storage then opening the smell can be quite strong. This will dissipate when left in the open air for a few minutes.

If the smell lingers, seek advice before using.

If in doubt, throw it out.

To store meat products which are in Vacuum packaging?

- Remove from cartons and place on clean washable container trays, this will stop excess liquid from spilling if packaging fails
- Meats that have a covering of fats, such as beef striploin, should be laid in that container with the fat side up; this avoids blood pooling and discolouring fat
- Label should be facing out so they can be easily read by staff.



Please note:

Time listed above for storage of meats only applies if temperature control is sufficient. Refrigeration of 3°C will cut short this time. It must be -1°C consistently.

While many things can be sealed this way it does not suit all foodstuffs.

Dry goods cannot be sealed under vacuum as it will crush them and render them useless.

When sealing dry goods the oxygen can be replaced with an inert gas like nitrogen.

Nitrogen does not allow the growth of mould and pathogens in the short term in dry goods. High moisture goods still need to be refrigerated.

Advantages of vacuum packing

- Vacuum packing is a good way of tenderising meats due to natural enzyme breakdown
- Gives a longer shelf life
- Reduces weight loss
- Cleaner way of storing meats.



Disadvantages

- Can give inconsistent results
- Some odour from meats after opening meats, this should fade after several minutes
- Some cut meat weeps excessively so there is a greater loss.

Vacuum packing allows for longer shelf life of meats in the fresh state because oxygen is removed and this slows down the rate of purification.

Vacuum packing menu items

If the product is going to be used within the next few days then there is no real need to vacuum seal. There is no benefit in the short term.

Products that have longer shelf life over 7 days at chilled temperature less than 5°C needs to be cooked by specific people who are licensed for this work.

Vacuum packing can free up cooking trays that may be needed for cooking rather than storage.

Storage requirements

All foods stored need to be protected from outside contamination.

Cooked foods need to be covered and stored at an appropriate temperature.

if food has been cooked and going to be served within the timeframe then it needs to be kept hot above 60°C until service time.

Store in hot box or bain-marie that is covered or sealed to retain the heat.

If the cooked food is going to be used the next day then it will need to be chilled using the 2 hour 4 hour rule and the temperature needs to be reduced to below 5°C within a 6 hour period or faster.

This food then needs to be wrapped and stored until required.

Reheating, if required, needs to be done as quickly as possible, within one hour to above 75°C.

4.2 Store buffet products appropriately in correct containers

Keeping all food products stored safely cannot be achieved if the container in which they are contained.

Storage containers must be impervious to liquids, not allow air to enter and must be in good condition:

- Storage container must be washable
- You must be able to sanitise them for future use
- They must be stackable for easier storage when not in use.



Stainless steel is the BEST container type for fresh meat storage:

- Cost is the biggest deterrent to using stainless steel.
- Food grade plastic is second best for use as storage containers, but can get scratched and needs to be changed when the scratching is too bad as scratches can harbour bacteria.
- Single plastic use items can be cost effective but must not be washed and re-used.

All storage containers must be able to be covered, either with a fitted lid or be small enough to be covered with plastic wrap to securely hold in produce:

- Reduces spillage
- Reduces cross contamination
- Easier to affix labelling.

Storage containers before assembly

- Containers used for storage of all buffet food must be of quality suitable for the job
- Containers must be sound quality, not broken
- Must be clean.

Storage containers after assembly

Container must be able to be securely wrapped to protect product from contamination and a label must be able to be attached.

Labelled

- When stored product must be labelled with relevant information
- Dated and priority given to maintain freshness; FIFO
- Consideration of freshness, quality and presentation.



4.3 Label stored buffet food correctly

Labelling

Labelling of buffet products is vitally important.

Label must contain:

- Description of the product: Chicken Fillets
- Name of the product: Moroccan style
- Date product was made: June 15th 2012
- Who packed the product: William the cook
- Use by date: June 17th 2012
- Storage conditions Store below 4°C
- Name of buffet for which it has been prepared: Smith 21st Birthday June 17

Who is it for?

All buffet foods must be allocated to specific function; especially in busy kitchen that supplies multiple outlets.

Labels must be legible. If they cannot be read by the end user then they are a waste of time.

In-correctly labelled products can cause problems due to food not being acceptable for human consumption.

Some labels can be colour coded but best colour to print is Black writing on white paper.

Handwritten labels must be written in water stable product. If you label food and it dissolves when it gets wet then all is wasted.



4.4 Store in correct conditions to maintain freshness and quality

Introduction

Temperature and humidity

Correct temperature maintenance will prevent shortened lifespan of food.

Equipment needs to be checked on a regular basis to ensure it is operating efficiently and effectively.

Stock rotation

Stock need to be dated when product comes into an enterprise so life can be monitored:

- First in and first out
- Keep stock to minimum and use old stock before new stock.

Buffets that are done on regular basis will normally have a 2 day preparation period. Food enters the kitchen and will have been served within the 2 days.

This is an efficiency process, food is in for minimal time before it is used for service to customers. Less money sitting in storeroom.

If some buffet foods can be frozen and it can be made in house it may be more efficient to make in larger batches and then freeze.

Example: Lasagne; if using one tray per day; make a batch of 20 trays then freeze, removing from freezer as required in time to thaw and reheat within food safety plan guidelines. Making twenty trays in one batch is more cost effective making 4 separate batches of 5 trays.



Producing on daily basis

Salads can be prepared early in the morning but not required until the evening then these will have to be kept in a state that will not make them unacceptable later in the day.

Keep them wrapped up and chilled at a temperature of less than 5 degrees Celsius.



Reporting faults

If equipment is found to be not operating efficiently than it needs to be reported to supervisor and then to maintenance personnel for corrective action to take place.

Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer.

You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project by the date agreed with your Trainer.

Buffet take planning; so the student must plan for buffet in many ways.

For this section the student needs to write a report on the following criteria.

4.1 Store fresh or vacuum sealed items:

- Define correct way of storing all foods.

4.2. Store buffet items in correct containers:

- Give an outline on the type of containers that can be used to store foods
- What condition the containers have to be in when food is being stored in them?

4.3. Label products as required:

- What are the requirements for labelling foods?

4.4. Store in correct conditions to maintain freshness and quality:

- Define the condition that all of the food for the buffet needs to be stored to maintain in its optimum condition
 - How long can it be stored to be classified as fresh?
-

Summary

Store buffet items

Store fresh and or vacuum packed items correctly

- Fresh high risk foods need to be chilled and kept at a temperature that will minimise the growth of bacteria; less than 5°C for up to 3 days.

Store buffet products appropriately in correct containers

- Containers must be food grade
- Must be in good condition
- Must be clean
- Must be able to be sealed.

Label stored buffet food correctly

- All foods needs to be labelled
- Name of the product
- Date of manufacture
- Use by date
- Who made the product
- Name of the buffet for which the food will be used.

Store in correct conditions to maintain freshness and quality

- Store foods so they are protected from adverse conditions
- Keep covered
- Purchase only what is required for the purchasing cycle to meet projected production needs.

Presentation of written work

1. Introduction

It is important for students to present carefully prepared written work. Written presentation in industry must be professional in appearance and accurate in content. If students develop good writing skills whilst studying, they are able to easily transfer those skills to the workplace.

2. Style



Students should write in a style that is simple and concise. Short sentences and paragraphs are easier to read and understand. It helps to write a plan and at least one draft of the written work so that the final product will be well organized. The points presented will then follow a logical sequence and be relevant. Students should frequently refer to the question asked, to keep 'on track'. Teachers recognize and are critical of work that does not answer the question, or is 'padded' with irrelevant material. In summary, remember to:

- Plan ahead
- Be clear and concise
- Answer the question
- Proofread the final draft.

3. Presenting Written Work

Types of written work

Students may be asked to write:

- Short and long reports
- Essays
- Records of interviews
- Questionnaires
- Business letters
- Resumes.



Format

All written work should be presented on A4 paper, single-sided with a left-hand margin. If work is word-processed, one-and-a-half or double spacing should be used. Handwritten work must be legible and should also be well spaced to allow for ease of reading. New paragraphs should not be indented but should be separated by a space. Pages must be numbered. If headings are also to be numbered, students should use a logical and sequential system of numbering.

Cover Sheet

All written work should be submitted with a cover sheet stapled to the front that contains:

- The student's name and student number
- The name of the class/unit
- The due date of the work
- The title of the work
- The teacher's name
- A signed declaration that the work does not involve plagiarism.

Keeping a Copy

Students must keep a copy of the written work in case it is lost. This rarely happens but it can be disastrous if a copy has not been kept.

Inclusive language

This means language that includes every section of the population. For instance, if a student were to write 'A nurse is responsible for the patients in her care at all times' it would be implying that all nurses are female and would be excluding male nurses.

Examples of appropriate language are shown on the right:

Mankind	<i>Humankind</i>
Barman/maid	<i>Bar attendant</i>
Host/hostess	<i>Host</i>
Waiter/waitress	<i>Waiter or waiting staff</i>

Recommended reading

Bailey, Adrian & Ortiz, Elisabeth Lambert; 2003; *The book of ingredients*, Michael Joseph

Hobday.Cara; 2010; *Food Presentation Secrets: Styling Techniques of Professionals*; Firefly Books

McWilliams, Margaret; 2013 (10th edition); *Food fundamentals*; Pearson

McWilliams, Margaret; 2013 (11th edition); *Illustrated guide to food preparation*; Pearson

McVety.P, Ware.B, Ware.C; 2008 (3rd edition); *Fundamentals of Menu Planning*; Wiley

Leonard.E; 2011; *Modern Buffets: Blueprint for Success* ;Wiley

Scanlon.N; 2012 (4th edition); *Catering Management*; Wiley

Styler.Christopher; 2006; *Working the Plate: The Art of Food Presentation*; Houghton Mifflin Harcourt

The Culinary Institute of America (CIA); 2011 (9th edition); *The Professional Chef*; Wiley

The Culinary Institute of America (CIA); 2014 (4th edition); *Techniques of Healthy Cooking*; Wiley

The Culinary Institute of America (CIA); 2012 (4th edition); *Garde Manger: The Art and Craft of the Cold Kitchen*; Wiley

Traster.Daniel; 2013; *Foundations of Menu Planning*; Prentice Hall

Trainee evaluation sheet

Plan, prepare and display a buffet service

The following statements are about the competency you have just completed.

Please tick the appropriate box	Agree	Don't Know	Do Not Agree	Does Not Apply
There was too much in this competency to cover without rushing.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Most of the competency seemed relevant to me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency was at the right level for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I got enough help from my trainer.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The amount of activities was sufficient.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency allowed me to use my own initiative.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My training was well-organized.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer had time to answer my questions.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I understood how I was going to be assessed.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I was given enough time to practice.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer feedback was useful.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Enough equipment was available and it worked well.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The activities were too hard for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐

The best things about this unit were:

The worst things about this unit were:

The things you should change in this unit are:

Trainee Self-Assessment Checklist

As an indicator to your Trainer/Assessor of your readiness for assessment in this unit please complete the following and hand to your Trainer/Assessor.

Plan, prepare and display a buffet service

		Yes	No*
Element 1: Plan a buffet display and service			
1.1	Plan a buffet display and service appropriate to client needs	☐	☐
1.2	Plan layout, display and presentation of the buffet	☐	☐
1.3	Calculate quantities required and food costs components of buffet	☐	☐
1.4	Select appropriate food items	☐	☐
1.5	Identify and prepare a variety of buffet centre pieces	☐	☐
Element 2: Prepare and produce buffet dishes			
2.1	Select appropriate preparation and cooking methods for dishes on buffet menu	☐	☐
2.2	Glaze buffet foods were appropriate	☐	☐
2.3	Hold prepared products as required prior to presenting	☐	☐
2.4	Prepare garnishes, sauces and accompaniments for appropriate buffet dishes	☐	☐
2.5	Use trimming and leftovers	☐	☐
Element 3: Display buffet dishes			
3.1	Present buffet products	☐	☐
3.2	Hold prepared products as required for duration of buffet service	☐	☐
3.3	Minimise wastage through presentation and replenishing	☐	☐
3.4	Display buffet dishes attractively	☐	☐

		Yes	No*
Element 4: Store buffet items			
4.1	Store fresh and or vacuum packed items correctly	☐	☐
4.2	Store buffet products appropriately in correct containers	☐	☐
4.3	Label stored buffet food correctly	☐	☐
4.4	Store in correct conditions to maintain freshness and quality	☐	☐

Statement by Trainee:

I believe I am ready to be assessed on the following as indicated above:

Signed: _____ **Date:** ____ / ____ / ____

Note:

For all boxes where a **No*** is ticked, please provide details of the extra steps or work you need to do to become ready for assessment.

